AMANDA TA

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Education

San Diego State University *Aug 2024 – Present*
Bachelor of Arts in Psychology San Diego, CA
Cumulative GPA: **3.56**, Department GPA: **3.8**

Research Skills & Interests

Theory:	Social, Policy, & Environmental Factors
Statistical Methods:	Descriptive statistics, t-tests, ANOVA, correlation, linear regression (SPSS)
Research Methods:	Dataset construction and cleaning, qualitative coding (thematic analysis), survey & interview design, EEG data acquisition
Software:	R, SPSS, Pycorder, Microsoft Excel

Research Experience

Research Assistant, Cognitive Affective Psychopathology & Psychophysiology Lab *Feb 2026 – Present*
Kappenman Laboratory, SDSU – PI: Emily Kappenman, Ph.D. San Diego, CA

Neural Correlates of Cognitive Control in Healthy Adults (ongoing)

- Collected and managed EEG datasets from healthy adult participants during a cognitive control task
- Monitored task performance and ensured high-quality EEG signal acquisition during experimental sessions
- Prepared and documented raw EEG datasets for preprocessing and downstream analysis

Research Assistant, Policy Research Center *Sep 2025 – Present*
Center for Tobacco and the Environment, SDSU – PI: Georg Matt, Ph.D., Mentor: Lydia Greiner, Ph.D. Kearny Mesa, CA

Tobacco smoke remediation practices in San Diego County (ongoing)

- Prepared introduction and methods sections for a mixed-methods study investigating residential tobacco smoke remediation practices and thirdhand smoke contamination
- Developed a novel database of **100** remediation and cleaning businesses and certified professionals using IICRC records, business directories, and public databases

Smoking and vaping policies in newly constructed, state-funded multiunit housing in California

- Integrated multi-source data (administrative records and primary survey data) to evaluate real-world implementation of smoking and vaping policies in state-subsidized housing
- Conducted structured qualitative coding of interview data to operationalize smoking and vaping lease policies and enforcement procedures into analyzable variables
- Synthesized interview data and survey responses to identify patterns in lease policy inclusion and enforcement
- Interpreted findings to highlight inconsistencies, ambiguous enforcement mechanisms, and gaps in lease disclosure

Academic Presentations

- **Ta, A.**, Matt, G. E., Woodridge, G., & Greiner, L. (**2026**). Smoking and vaping policies in newly constructed, state-funded multiunit housing in California [Poster presentation, S^{3}]. SDSU Symposium, San Diego State University, San Diego, CA.
- **Ta, A.**, Matt, G. E., Woodridge, G., & Greiner, L. (**2026**). Smoking and vaping policies in newly constructed, state-funded multiunit housing in California. Poster to be presented at the Third Annual Research Symposium on Tobacco and the Environment, Southeast Live Well Center, San Diego, CA.

Honors

Dean's Award Honoree, Top Poster Presentation *Feb 2026*
SDSU College of Sciences – Top presentation, College of Sciences 2026 SDSU Student Symposium (S^3)

SDSU Merit Scholarship *2024 – Present*
4-year full tuition scholarship for outstanding local incoming students

Outreach

Vice President, The Ground Up Project: San Diego (tgupsd.org) *Jan 2024 – Sep 2025*
Jamul, CA

- Organized and coordinated the distribution of over **4,100** lbs of food, clothes, books, and hygiene supplies to local charity organizations through large-scale donation drives, particularly for those navigating humanitarian crises

Course Projects

Future of LSD in Clinical Treatment *Sep 2025 – Oct 2025*
Physiological Psychology – Advisor: Nirelia Moranton, Ph.D. San Diego, CA

- Conducted and presented a systematic literature review consisting of **8** recent academic articles with **3** other team members on clinical applications of LSD, with emphasis on **5**-HT2A receptor binding mechanisms demonstrated in cortical neurons of mice

Professional Membership

- American Psychological Association
- Psi Chi, International Honor Society in Psychology & Psychology Club